carried out by the Red Force (REDFOR) branch of the Army Training Command (ARTRAC), which was then headed by Lt Gen Madhok, who had been my colleague in PP Dte. In theory, since the ARTRAC is not under the Regional Command, it can make an independent plan, not always in consonance with what the Command would want to do. Hence a parallel Yellow Land was created and I was appointed to head it, since I had served in all the Corps and had also done the same job for the 3 Corps War Game. By now, Eastern Command had been taken over by Lt Gen MMS Rai (Engineers). The fulcrum around which the conduct depended was the MGGS, Maj Gen Bipin Rawat, who also acted as the Control on behalf of the Army Commander. Therefore, despite the 'enemy' being from an outside agency, the key to how the war game was to unfold remained within the Command. Not a very satisfactory arrangement, if one really wanted to validate your plans against the best that the enemy could throw at you. I proceeded to make my independent plans and the ARTRAC team made theirs, and it was decided that I should make the presentation to the Chief. Lt Gen Madhok came to know of this plan to undermine the role of the ARTRAC and offered to pull back his team, which would then not be present when the Chief visited. This would have created an embarrassing situation and in the end, it was the ARTRAC plan that was played. I did not mind though, as I had gained valuable experience, but this incident did give me food for thought, on the role of the ARTRAC and conduct of war games.

The AR Battalions continued carrying out their assigned tasks under the umbrella of the ceasefire. The militant cadres would roam about in ones and twos, with pistols tucked in their waistbands and hidden under their shirts, extorting money from the locals. The locals were quite fed up, as they had to pay

Copyright © Penguin Random House India
Not for circulation